

1. Take some time to go over this chapter again if needed.
2. If you'd like to take things a step further, visit the various resources mentioned throughout the chapter for more detailed information on how the stock market works.

CLEVER GIRL INVESTOR: MEET JENNIFER “JENNY” COOMBS

Jennifer “Jenny” N. Coombs, CRPC[®], is an associate professor at the College for Financial Planning. She is the creator, lead author, and lead instructor for the Chartered SRI Counselor[™] (CSRIC[®]) designation education program, which is the first sustainable, responsible impact investing financial designation education program in the United States. She also serves as a subject matter expert on a number of the College's investment courses and serves as the chair of the College's Research Committee. In her spare time, Jenny runs the website Grad Money (gradmoney.org), which she founded to help recent graduates demystify investing in the stock market.

Q. As someone with a strong investing background and who currently works in the financial planning field, how does a beginner navigate through the sometimes unnecessary complexities of investing?

A. I think that investing is a lot simpler than one would be led to believe. I once had a mentor equate investing to putting together a puzzle: you don't need to have all the puzzle pieces in place to see what the picture will be, you just need enough so that you can see the trend before anyone else does.

Q. One of the most common statements made about investing is “I don't know where to invest.” What are some key things people should consider when trying to figure out where to invest?

A. This is often the biggest excuse people give for not getting started, but really, it's quite simple: just *get started*. The first place to invest is in companies that you really like or in companies whose products and services you use all the time. For me personally, I eat at Chipotle Mexican Grill at